each of which brought its relative advantage to the joint effort, enriched the wisdom, experience, knowledge, and skills of the Mossad and, I assume, also of the Shin Bet.

In conclusion, when you are the master of your own research and assessment abilities, and when you become a central axis in the intelligence war, you reach a maturity that gives you the ability and the right (which I believe is mandatory) to make your voice heard on everything from assessments, to EEI priorities, to the overall work plan of the community, including the allocation of resources. The Agranat Commission was indeed a catalyst for changing the research and assessment system from one that was monolithic to one that was pluralistic, but the interpretation of the issue of pluralism, as given by Shlomo Gazit, who was appointed head of Military Intelligence after the Yom Kippur War, was that it should be implemented *within* the Intelligence Corps and not in the entire intelligence community. The system he implemented was, in effect, pluralism between the research branch of the General Staff and the intelligence departments of the three IDF commands. This method had no professional logic, and it eroded the central role of the intelligence of the regional command—to be the intelligence officer of the arena for which it is responsible—but it enabled MI to continue to claim sole ownership of the title of national intelligence assessor. Reality proved that it was a rearguard action, which over time proved to be a failure.

During my tenure as director of the Mossad (1989–96), I worked with four MI heads. The first was Amnon Lipkin-Shahak, who was an officer and a gentleman. In late July 1990, we both accompanied Defense Minister Moshe Arens on an official visit to Washington. The visit's main purpose was to present Secretary of Defense Richard Cheney with the Israeli perception of the threat of Iraq's unconventional weapons. For the visit, the Mossad put together a "white paper" containing all of Iraq's transgressions with regard to WMD to pass on to the Americans. The briefing to the secretary of defense, on either side of whom sat about a dozen US generals as well as a few others in civilian dress, following Moshe Arens's opening remarks, was given by the head of the Mossad's WMD division and myself (I will expand on this in the chapter on the First Gulf War of January 1991).

The next head of Military Intelligence with whom I worked was Uri Sagi. Sagi's perception of his role was unambiguous—he believed that he, as head of MI, bore the national responsibility for intelligence assessment and